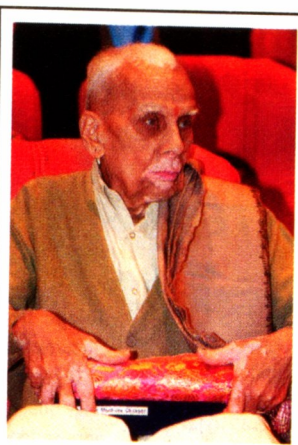


obituary

Dance of Life

He may have been little celebrated in this era of low culture but Guru Ammannur Madhva Chakyar was a true great, the finest kutiyattam performer of the previous century. One of the oldest art forms in the world, kutiyattam has a lot to thank Madhva for its exalted status. Once performed exclusively inside the kutampalam, inside temples, it is today a world heritage art form.

Initiated into kutiyattam at the age of seven and trained by his uncles, the legendary Chachu Chakyar and Ammanur Valiya, Madhva went on to make his arangettam at the age of 11. In a career spanning nearly 80 years, he travelled across India



Ammannur M. Chakyar
1917-2008

and the world creating a new repertoire for the classical art form. He wrote and published acting manuals on the subject, apart from holding positions as visiting professor at Kerala Kalamandalam and co-founding The Ammannur Chachu Chakyar Smaraka Gurukulam with his

disciple G. Venu.

Recipient of the Padma-bhushan in 2002, Madhva has been guru to many names in kutiyattam like G.Venu, Usha Nangiar, Sooraj Nambiar, Margi Madhu, Tomoe Tara Irino and Rathy Nangiar, besides being mentor to many modern theatre practitioners in the country. Stories about his prowess abound. A favourite among all artistes is when he threw an imaginary mountain into the audience. So powerful was his performance that two members from the audience fell off their seats.

Creating a tremendous void in the world of performance, the *abhinaya* and *bhava* of the last of the dance stalwarts who breathed his last at 91, will forever be missed and remembered for his achievements.

by **Nirmala Ravindran**

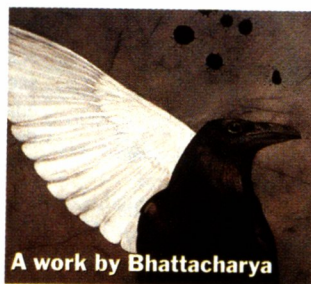
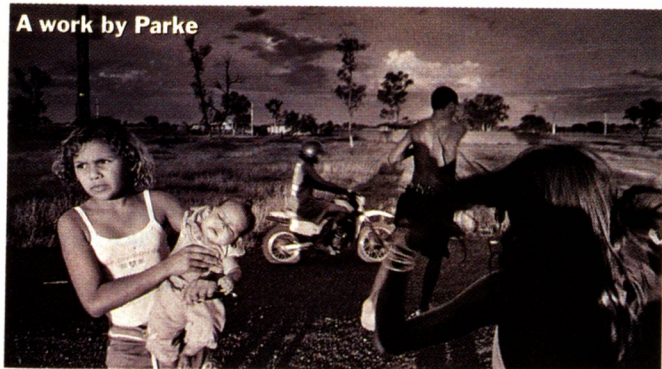
recommendations

Brushes and Clicks

DELHI Well-known photographer, Trent Parke, documented his journey around Australia over a two-year period, examining 'the current and changing state of the Australian nation'. Capturing the mood of a still young and emerging nation, he examined the disjuncture

between the perception of the Australian 'way of life', with its nostalgia and romanticism, and the more complex reality. The exhibition *Minutes to Midnight* opened for the first time at the Australian Centre for Photography as part of the Sydney Arts Festival in 2005. See his photographs, on display at AIFACS Gallery. From July 12 to 27.

A work by Parke



A work by Bhattacharya

KOLKATA The power of monochrome, both in paintings as well as installations, is being brought to the fore at the Gandhara Art Gallery. Titled *Magic of Monochrome*, the exhibition features 14 artists who have exhibited their art without the help of a riot of colours. Among them are Aditya Basak, Amitava Das, Chandra Bhattacharya, Ganesh Haloi, Akbar Padamsee and Jogen Chowdhury. On till July 18.

by **Elora Sen**

music reviews

Pulsating Tunes

BACHNA AE HASEENO



YRF Music
Rs 150

The Vishal-Shekhar duo is quickly becoming Bollywood's resident candy-

flossers. This album has the right mix of cool singers and funky beats. *Khuda jaane* is a surefire hit, while *Aahista aahista* is designed to get your feet off the floor. The original *Karz* song *Bachna ae haseeno* by Kishore Kumar has been remixed too, quite smoothly.



Sa Re Ga Ma
Rs 125

LAMHE Monsoon has played an important part in films—be it the meeting of lovers or

the cry for a lost one. This album comprises 15 film songs based on the rains. Listen to the classic song *Garjat barsat sawan aayo re (Barsat Ki Raat)* by Suman Kalyanpur and Kamal Barot or the duet *Sawan ka mahina (Milan)* by Lata Mangeshkar and Mukesh or R.D. Burman's hit, *Sawan ke jhoole pade (Jurmana)*.

BLUE INCANTATION



Indian Beat
Rs 350

It is a meeting of the East and West. A collaboration by Jerry Garcia with Sanjay

Mishra on the guitar captures Western sensitivity along with traditional Indian music. Mishra has a brilliant sense of melody and his guitar is exuberantly lyrical. The pieces are evocative with catchy tabla beats and flute sounds. Fusion fantastic.

by **S. Sahaya Ranjit**